

WINDOWS PRODUCTIVITY

FULL VISUAL STUDY MANUAL

Windows Productivity Workspace

Use the desktop as an organised launch point

Start

Apps, power and search

Taskbar

Pinned and running apps

Desktop

Shortcuts and working area

Notifications

System and app alerts

Course Code	EDA-WIN-112
Level	Beginner to Intermediate
Duration	6 Weeks (19 Lessons)
Certificate	Professional Certificate in Windows Productivity
Prerequisite	Computer Appreciation
Learning Format	Classroom + Guided Practicals + Final Productivity Project

This course focuses on normal learner-facing Windows productivity. Advanced administrative controls, security bypasses and risky system modifications are outside the beginner practical scope.

Course Introduction

Windows Productivity teaches learners to use the Windows desktop, Start menu, taskbar, File Explorer, search, window management, shortcuts, clipboard, screenshots, settings, accessibility, notifications, security, storage and backup features efficiently.

Learning Objectives

- Navigate the Windows desktop, Start menu and taskbar.
- Organise files and folders using File Explorer.
- Use Windows Search effectively.
- Manage multiple application windows.
- Apply useful keyboard shortcuts.
- Capture and manage screenshots responsibly.
- Use normal display, sound and accessibility settings.
- Apply safe everyday Windows security habits.
- Build an organised end-to-end productivity workflow.

Course Structure

1. Lesson 1: Introduction to Windows Productivity
2. Lesson 2: The Windows Desktop and Start Menu
3. Lesson 3: File Explorer Fundamentals
4. Lesson 4: Creating, Naming and Organising Files
5. Lesson 5: Copy, Move, Rename and Delete
6. Lesson 6: Windows Search
7. Lesson 7: Managing Application Windows
8. Lesson 8: Essential Windows Keyboard Shortcuts
9. Lesson 9: Clipboard and Clipboard History
10. Lesson 10: Screenshots and Snipping Tool
11. Lesson 11: Taskbar, Pins and Jump Lists
12. Lesson 12: Windows Settings for Everyday Users
13. Lesson 13: Accessibility and Ease-of-Use Features
14. Lesson 14: Notifications and Focus
15. Lesson 15: Windows Security and Safe Everyday Use
16. Lesson 16: Managing Storage and Recycle Bin
17. Lesson 17: Multitasking and Efficient Workflows
18. Lesson 18: Backup and Cloud-Synchronised Folders
19. Lesson 19: Final Windows Productivity Project

Lesson 1: Introduction to Windows Productivity

Introduction

Windows productivity means using the operating system efficiently to organise files, launch applications, manage windows, search, capture information and complete everyday digital work.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in introduction to windows productivity.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for introduction to windows productivity.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: The operating system provides the workspace in which applications run.

Key point: Productivity comes from organised habits as well as shortcuts.

Key point: Normal user settings can be customised without changing advanced system controls.

Key point: Files should be saved deliberately rather than left scattered across Downloads and Desktop.

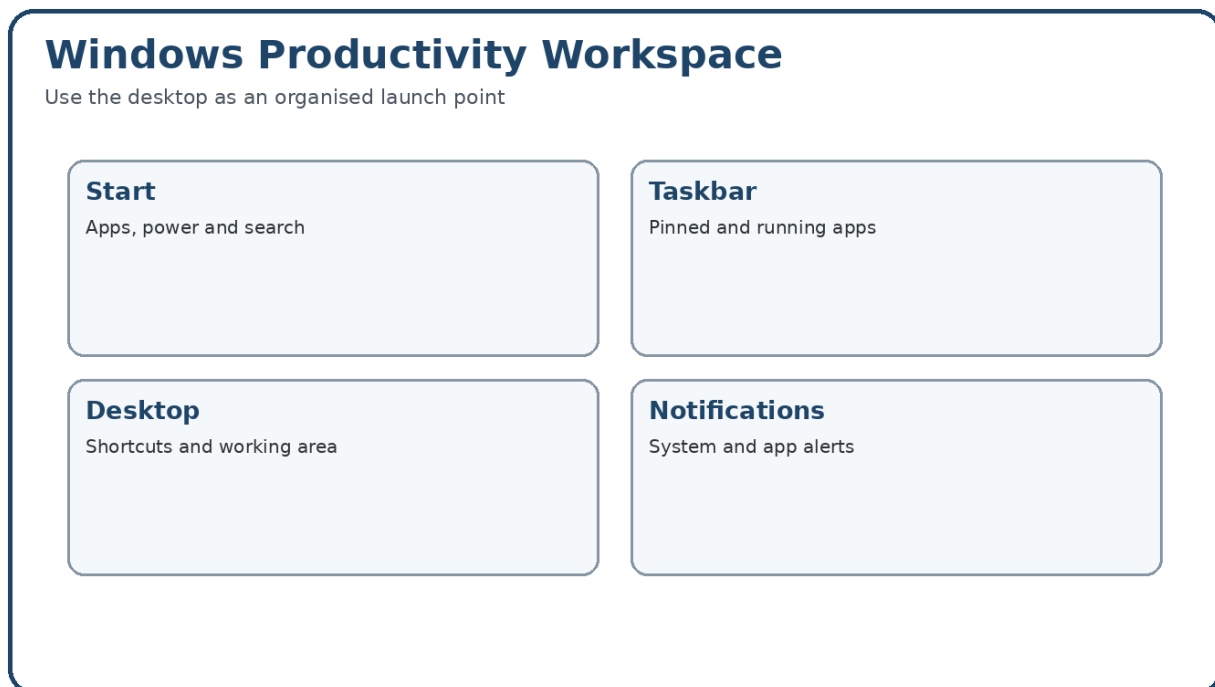


Figure 1: Instructional visual for Introduction to Windows Productivity.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Identify Start, taskbar, desktop and notification area.
2. Open two normal applications.
3. Switch between them.
4. Create a folder named Windows Productivity Practice.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy learners use Windows as the foundation for Word, Excel, browsers and other digital tools.

Review Questions

20. What is the productivity purpose of introduction to windows productivity?
21. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
22. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
23. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 1 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 2: The Windows Desktop and Start Menu

Introduction

The desktop, Start menu and taskbar provide fast access to applications, files and system controls.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in the windows desktop and start menu.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for the windows desktop and start menu.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Start provides apps, search, account and power options.

Key point: The taskbar shows pinned and running applications.

Key point: Desktop shortcuts are links, not necessarily the original file.

Key point: A clean desktop reduces clutter and makes important items easier to find.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Start.
2. Pin or identify a commonly used app if authorised.
3. Open File Explorer from the taskbar or Start.
4. Return to the desktop using a normal method.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy lab computers can pin frequently used learning applications while keeping the desktop uncluttered.

Review Questions

24. What is the productivity purpose of the windows desktop and start menu?
25. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
26. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
27. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 2 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 3: File Explorer Fundamentals

Introduction

File Explorer is the main Windows tool for browsing drives, folders and files.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in file explorer fundamentals.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for file explorer fundamentals.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: The navigation pane gives access to common locations.

Key point: The address bar shows the current location.

Key point: Views can display names, dates, types and sizes.

Key point: File extensions help identify formats when shown.

Key point: Users should understand a file's location before moving or deleting it.

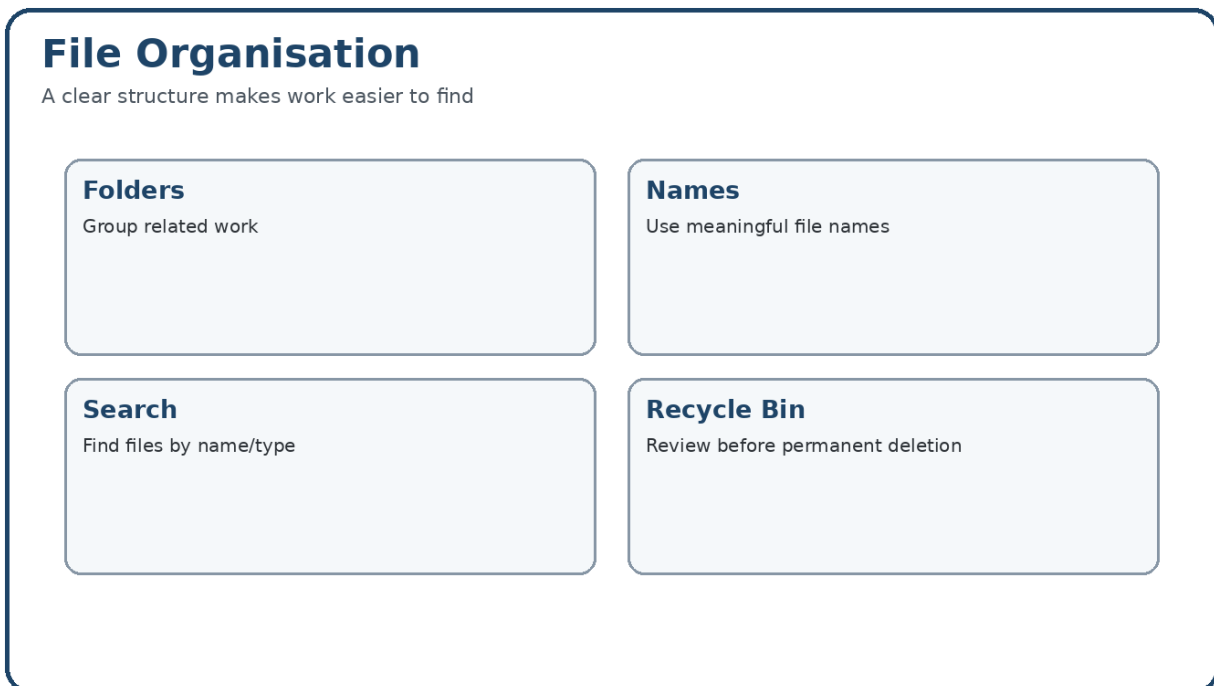


Figure 3: Instructional visual for File Explorer Fundamentals.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open File Explorer.
2. Navigate to Documents.
3. Create a practice folder.
4. Create two subfolders: Current Work and Archive.
5. Observe Details view if available.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Learners can keep each Academy course in a dedicated folder instead of mixing every file together.

Review Questions

28. What is the productivity purpose of file explorer fundamentals?
29. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
30. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
31. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 3 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 4: Creating, Naming and Organising Files

Introduction

Consistent naming makes files easier to search, share and archive.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in creating, naming and organising files.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for creating, naming and organising files.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use descriptive names that explain content.

Key point: Dates can be written consistently, for example 2026-09-15.

Key point: Avoid confusing names such as final-final-new.

Key point: Keep editable originals separate from exported copies.

Key point: Use folders that reflect project or course structure.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create three harmless practice files.
2. Rename them with clear subject names.
3. Move one into Archive.
4. Create an Exports folder.
5. Explain which file is the working master.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy course teams can use names such as Excel-Assignment-01 rather than Document1.

Review Questions

32. What is the productivity purpose of creating, naming and organising files?
33. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
34. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
35. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 4 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 5: Copy, Move, Rename and Delete

Introduction

File operations are basic productivity skills, but they should be performed carefully.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in copy, move, rename and delete.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for copy, move, rename and delete.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Copy creates another instance while leaving the original.

Key point: Move changes location.

Key point: Rename changes the label, not the file content.

Key point: Delete normally sends local files to Recycle Bin first, depending on context.

Key point: Permanent deletion should be used cautiously.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Copy a practice file.
2. Move the copy to another folder.
3. Rename it.
4. Delete only the practice copy.
5. Restore it from Recycle Bin if available.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Learners should practise on disposable files before managing important Academy documents.

Review Questions

36. What is the productivity purpose of copy, move, rename and delete?
37. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
38. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
39. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 5 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 6: Windows Search

Introduction

Windows Search can locate apps, settings and local files more quickly than browsing many folders manually.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in windows search.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for windows search.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Search by a distinctive part of a file name.

Key point: Results can include apps, settings and documents.

Key point: Filters may narrow results by type or location.

Key point: Good file names improve search quality.

Key point: Search results should still be checked before opening or deleting files.

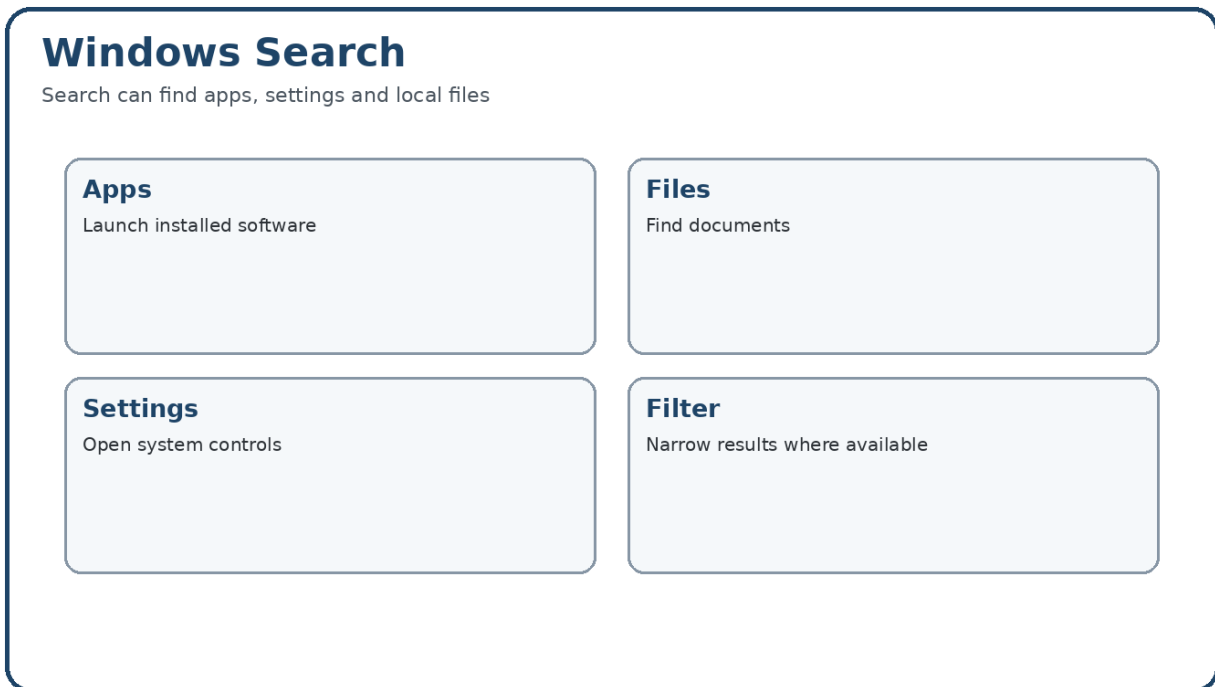


Figure 6: Instructional visual for Windows Search.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a file with a unique practice name.
2. Use Windows Search to find it.
3. Search for Display settings.
4. Search for Calculator.
5. Record which search was fastest.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

A learner can quickly locate an assignment when the file has a meaningful name.

Review Questions

40. What is the productivity purpose of windows search?
41. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
42. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
43. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 6 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 7: Managing Application Windows

Introduction

Window-management tools help users work with several applications without losing track of tasks.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in managing application windows.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for managing application windows.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Minimise hides a window without closing it.

Key point: Maximise uses most available screen space.

Key point: Snap can arrange windows side by side.

Key point: Alt+Tab switches among open applications.

Key point: Virtual desktops can separate groups of tasks on supported Windows versions.

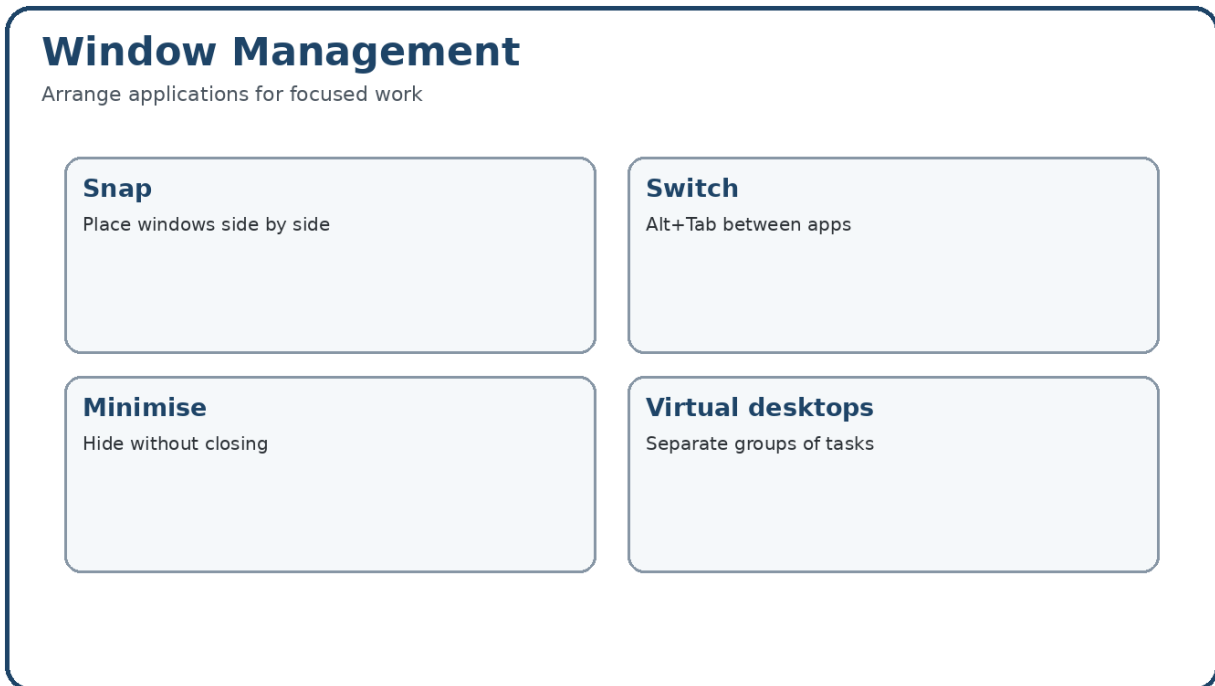


Figure 7: Instructional visual for Managing Application Windows.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open a browser and text editor.
2. Snap them side by side.
3. Switch using Alt+Tab.
4. Minimise and restore one window.
5. Create a virtual desktop only if supported and authorised.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy learner can view course instructions on one side and type an assignment on the other.

Review Questions

44. What is the productivity purpose of managing application windows?
45. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
46. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
47. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 7 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 8: Essential Windows Keyboard Shortcuts

Introduction

Shortcuts reduce repeated pointer movement and can make common actions faster.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in essential windows keyboard shortcuts.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for essential windows keyboard shortcuts.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Win+E opens File Explorer.

Key point: Win+D shows the desktop.

Key point: Alt+Tab switches applications.

Key point: Win+L locks the computer.

Key point: Ctrl+C, Ctrl+X, Ctrl+V and Ctrl+Z work in many Windows applications.

Everyday Windows Shortcuts

Keyboard commands reduce repeated mouse work

Win+E Open File Explorer	Win+D Show desktop
Alt+Tab Switch apps	Win+Shift+S Open screenshot selection on supported Windows

Figure 8: Instructional visual for Essential Windows Keyboard Shortcuts.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Practise Win+E.
2. Open two apps and use Alt+Tab.
3. Copy and paste a practice sentence.
4. Use Win+D and return to your work.
5. Use Win+L only when appropriate and sign back in privately.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Keyboard shortcuts improve efficiency across Academy office and digital-skills courses.

Review Questions

48. What is the productivity purpose of essential windows keyboard shortcuts?
49. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
50. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
51. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 8 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 9: Clipboard and Clipboard History

Introduction

The clipboard temporarily holds copied or cut content. Windows may also provide optional clipboard history.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in clipboard and clipboard history.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for clipboard and clipboard history.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Copy preserves the source; Cut is intended to move selected content.

Key point: Pasting inserts the current clipboard content.

Key point: Clipboard history can hold several recent text/image items when enabled.

Key point: Sensitive information should not be casually stored in shared clipboard history.

Key point: Users should confirm the correct content before pasting.

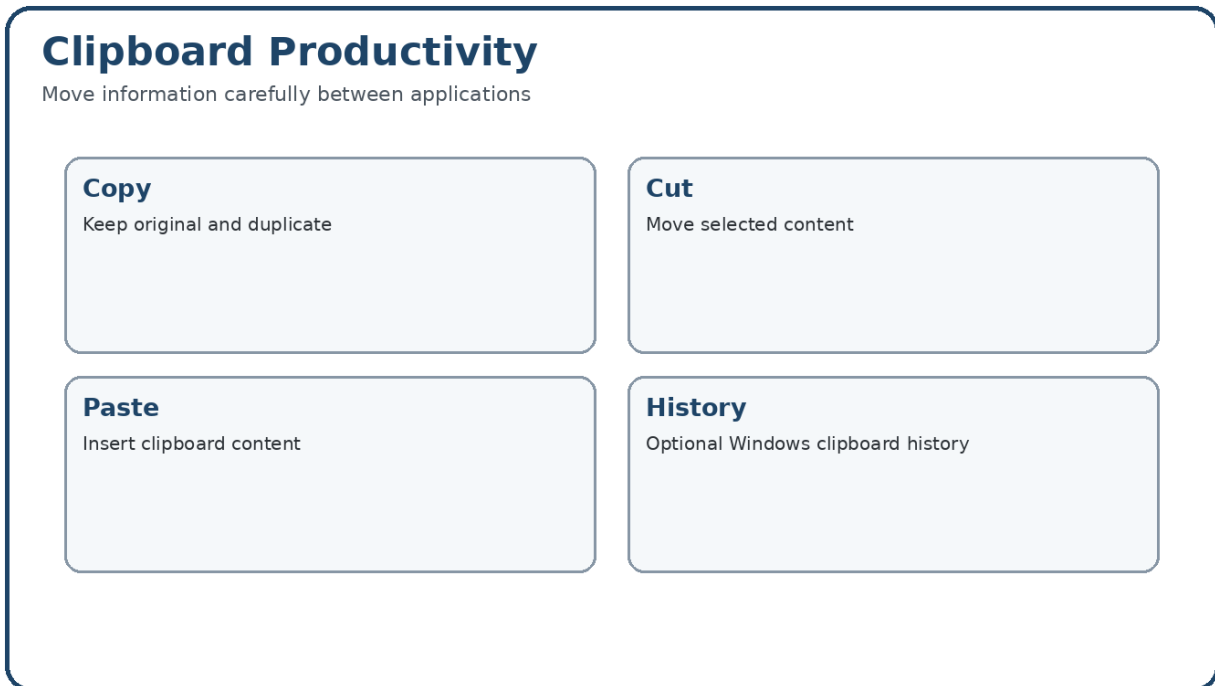


Figure 9: Instructional visual for Clipboard and Clipboard History.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Copy two short practice phrases.
2. Paste them into a document.
3. If clipboard history is enabled, view it using the normal Windows shortcut.
4. Clear only harmless practice entries if instructed.
5. Explain one privacy consideration.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Learners can move text between a browser and a document while avoiding copying private account information.

Review Questions

52. What is the productivity purpose of clipboard and clipboard history?
53. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
54. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
55. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 9 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 10: Screenshots and Snipping Tool

Introduction

Screenshots capture visual information for instructions, evidence or communication.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in screenshots and snipping tool.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for screenshots and snipping tool.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Snipping Tool can capture a region, window or screen depending on version.

Key point: Capture only what is necessary.

Key point: Crop or annotate to focus attention.

Key point: Check screenshots for names, messages or other private information before sharing.

Key point: Use clear file names and storage folders.

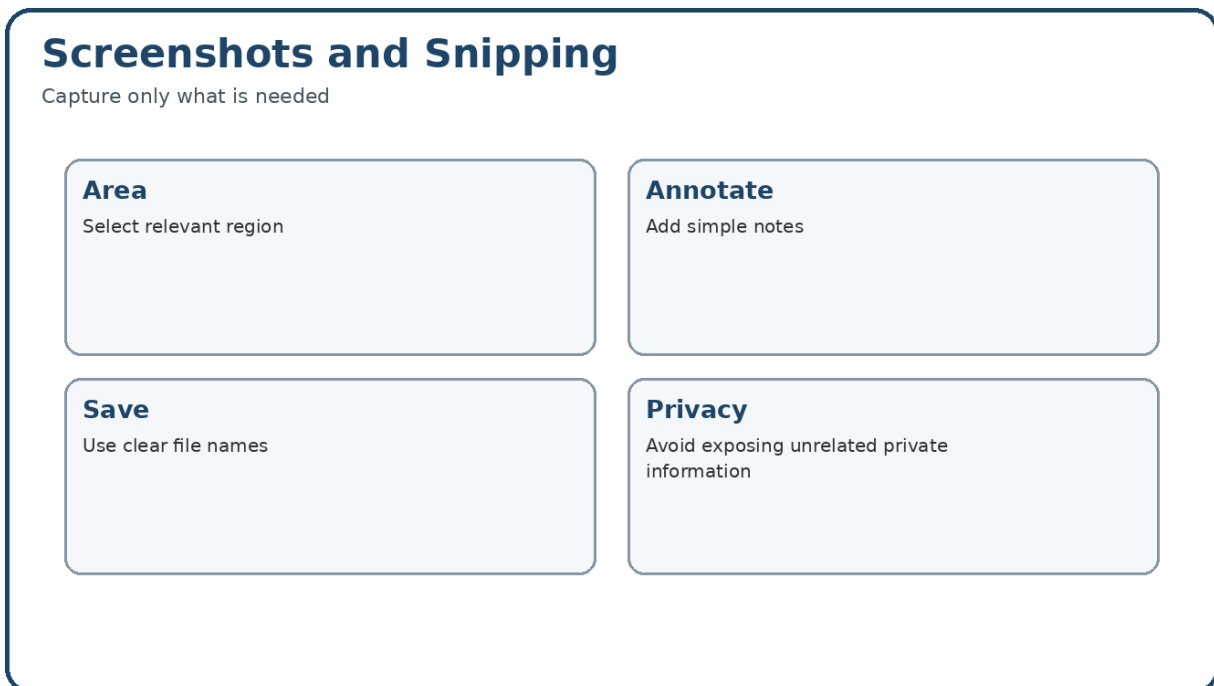


Figure 10: Instructional visual for Screenshots and Snipping Tool.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open a harmless practice window.
2. Capture only a small relevant area.
3. Add an arrow or note if the tool supports it.
4. Save the image in your practice folder.
5. Review it for unnecessary information before sharing.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy learners can submit a screenshot of a completed software exercise without exposing unrelated personal content.

Review Questions

56. What is the productivity purpose of screenshots and snipping tool?
57. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
58. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
59. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 10 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 11: Taskbar, Pins and Jump Lists

Introduction

The taskbar can be organised to reduce time spent searching for frequently used applications.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in taskbar, pins and jump lists.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for taskbar, pins and jump lists.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Pinned apps remain available even when closed.

Key point: Running apps are indicated on the taskbar.

Key point: Some apps provide jump lists or recent items.

Key point: Too many pins can create clutter.

Key point: Shared computers should avoid exposing private recent files unnecessarily.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Identify pinned versus running apps.
2. Pin one approved learning app if allowed.
3. Reorder taskbar icons if permitted.
4. Open a recent item only from your own practice work.
5. Remove an unnecessary pin.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy lab computers can use a standard set of approved pinned applications.

Review Questions

60. What is the productivity purpose of taskbar, pins and jump lists?
61. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
62. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
63. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 11 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 12: Windows Settings for Everyday Users

Introduction

Windows Settings provides normal controls for display, sound, devices, accounts, accessibility and updates.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in windows settings for everyday users.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for windows settings for everyday users.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Display scaling can improve readability.

Key point: Sound settings choose volume and output device.

Key point: Bluetooth/device settings manage supported peripherals.

Key point: Update status should be reviewed through official Windows settings.

Key point: Advanced administrator changes should be left to authorised staff.

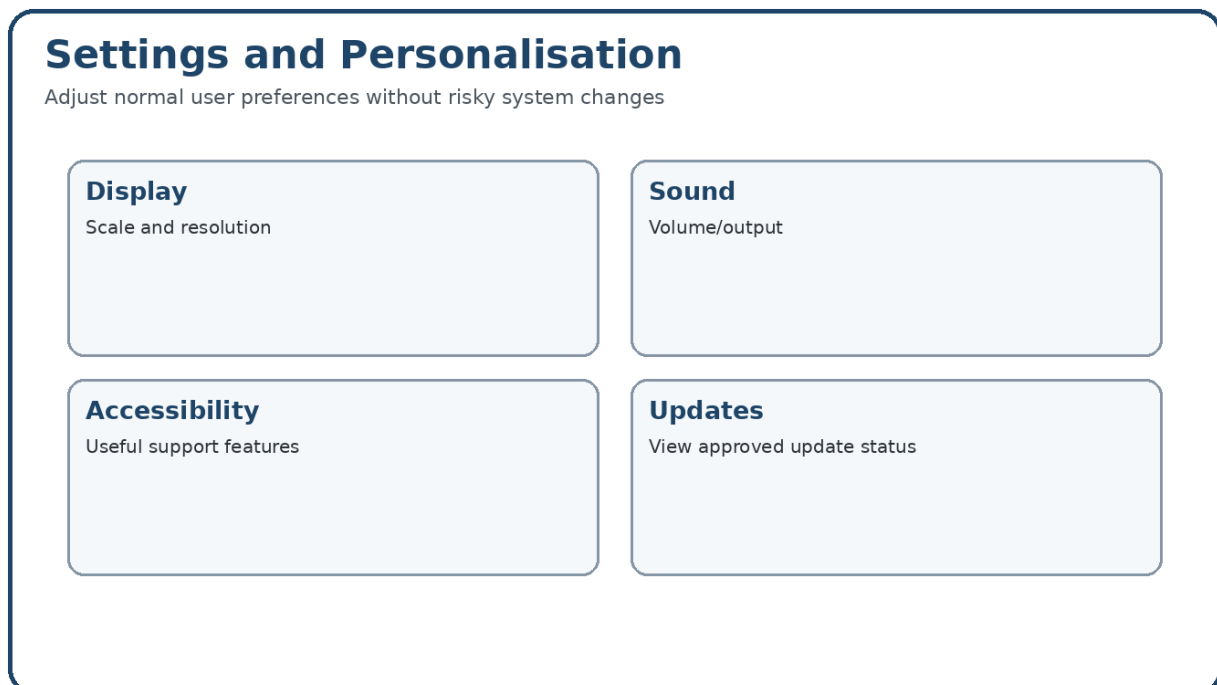


Figure 12: Instructional visual for Windows Settings for Everyday Users.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Settings.
2. Locate Display and Sound.
3. Record current scale and output device.
4. Locate Windows Update without bypassing controls.
5. Return to the main Settings page.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

First-line Academy support can guide users through ordinary settings without altering restricted policies.

Review Questions

64. What is the productivity purpose of windows settings for everyday users?
65. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
66. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
67. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 12 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 13: Accessibility and Ease-of-Use Features

Introduction

Windows includes features that can improve access and comfort for different users.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in accessibility and ease-of-use features.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for accessibility and ease-of-use features.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Text size and display scaling can improve readability.

Key point: Magnifier enlarges screen content.

Key point: Narrator is a built-in screen reader.

Key point: Voice access and speech features depend on Windows version, language and configuration.

Key point: Accessibility settings are useful productivity tools, not signs of reduced ability.

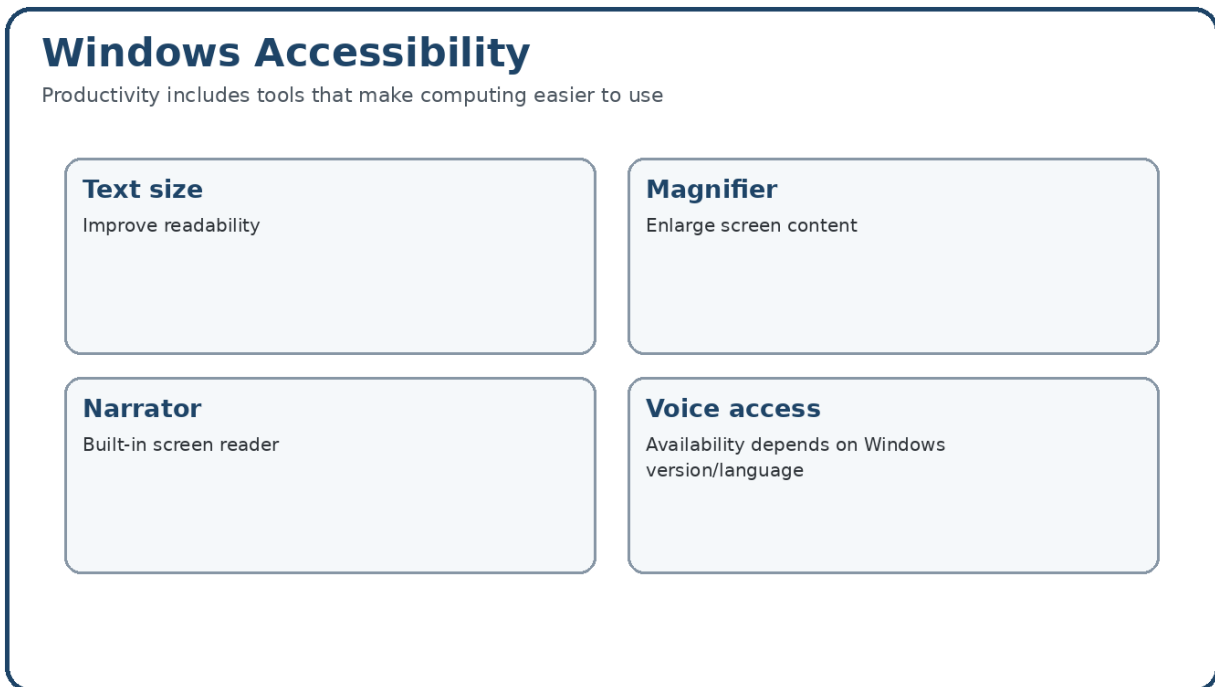


Figure 13: Instructional visual for Accessibility and Ease-of-Use Features.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Accessibility settings.
2. Locate Text size, Magnifier and Narrator.
3. Read the descriptions without changing settings unnecessarily.
4. Try one harmless display/readability feature if authorised.
5. Restore the original setting.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy can introduce accessibility options so learners know Windows can adapt to different study needs.

Review Questions

68. What is the productivity purpose of accessibility and ease-of-use features?
69. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
70. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
71. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 13 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 14: Notifications and Focus

Introduction

Notifications can be useful, but constant interruptions reduce concentration.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in notifications and focus.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for notifications and focus.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Notifications can be controlled by application.

Key point: Do Not Disturb or focus features can reduce interruptions on supported Windows versions.

Key point: Important system/security alerts should not be ignored.

Key point: Learners should distinguish useful reminders from unnecessary promotional notifications.

Key point: Settings should match the user's responsibilities.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open notification settings.
2. Review which apps can notify.
3. Do not disable security alerts.
4. Identify a focus or Do Not Disturb option if available.
5. Plan a distraction-reduced 20-minute study session.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

During an Academy practical test, unnecessary app notifications can be reduced while important system alerts remain available.

Review Questions

72. What is the productivity purpose of notifications and focus?
73. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
74. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
75. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 14 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 15: Windows Security and Safe Everyday Use

Introduction

Productivity should not come at the cost of account or device security.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in windows security and safe everyday use.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for windows security and safe everyday use.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Lock the computer when leaving it unattended.

Key point: Install software from trusted approved sources.

Key point: Keep supported Windows and applications updated.

Key point: Do not disable security controls to run unknown software.

Key point: Use separate authorised accounts where organisations require them.



Figure 15: Instructional visual for Windows Security and Safe Everyday Use.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Practise locking the computer with Win+L.
2. Open Windows Security status without changing administrator controls.
3. Check update status.
4. List three unsafe download behaviours.
5. Write the correct response to a suspicious security alert: stop and report.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy learners should protect shared lab sessions by locking devices and avoiding unknown downloads.

Review Questions

76. What is the productivity purpose of windows security and safe everyday use?
77. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
78. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
79. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 15 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 16: Managing Storage and Recycle Bin

Introduction

Windows provides tools to review storage and recover some accidentally deleted local files.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in managing storage and recycle bin.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for managing storage and recycle bin.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Storage settings show categories using disk space.

Key point: Recycle Bin can restore recently deleted local files in many cases.

Key point: Emptying Recycle Bin can make recovery harder.

Key point: Downloads should be reviewed periodically.

Key point: Important files need backups, not just local storage.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Storage settings.
2. Record free space.
3. Delete a disposable practice file.
4. Restore it from Recycle Bin.
5. Move an old practice file into Archive.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy lab maintenance can reduce clutter while preserving learner work that still matters.

Review Questions

80. What is the productivity purpose of managing storage and recycle bin?
81. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
82. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
83. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 16 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 17: Multitasking and Efficient Workflows

Introduction

A productive workflow combines file organisation, window management, shortcuts and deliberate saving.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in multitasking and efficient workflows.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for multitasking and efficient workflows.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Plan the task before opening many apps.

Key point: Keep related files in one project folder.

Key point: Use Snap and Alt+Tab for controlled multitasking.

Key point: Save regularly with meaningful names.

Key point: Close applications that are no longer needed.

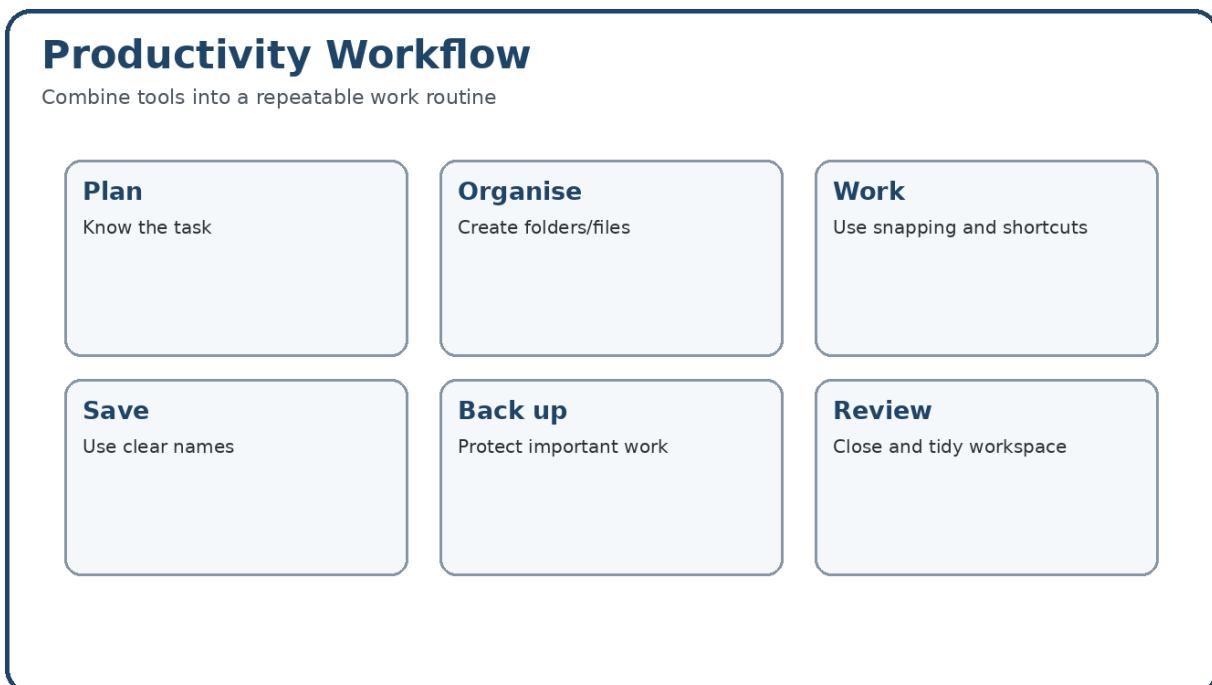


Figure 17: Instructional visual for Multitasking and Efficient Workflows.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a project folder.
2. Open instructions in one app and a document in another.
3. Snap them side by side.
4. Save the document into the project folder.
5. Close both apps and reopen the saved file.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

A learner can complete an assignment without losing files or repeatedly searching through open windows.

Review Questions

84. What is the productivity purpose of multitasking and efficient workflows?
85. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
86. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
87. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 17 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 18: Backup and Cloud-Synchronised Folders

Introduction

Windows computers may use local backup tools or cloud-synchronised folders. Users should understand where their files are stored.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in backup and cloud-synchronised folders.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for backup and cloud-synchronised folders.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: A synchronised folder can copy changes to a cloud service when configured.

Key point: Sync is not always a complete backup because deletions or changes may also synchronise.

Key point: Important files should follow the organisation's backup plan.

Key point: Check sync status before assuming a file is safely stored elsewhere.

Key point: Shared devices require care with account sign-in and sign-out.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Identify whether a practice folder is local or synchronised.
2. Create a harmless file in the approved location.
3. Observe the sync status if configured.
4. Create a second authorised backup copy.
5. Explain the difference between sync and backup.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy staff can keep approved course documents in managed cloud folders while maintaining separate backups.

Review Questions

88. What is the productivity purpose of backup and cloud-synchronised folders?
89. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
90. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?

91. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 18 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Lesson 19: Final Windows Productivity Project

Introduction

The final project combines the major Windows productivity skills in one realistic office-learning workflow.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main concepts in final windows productivity project.
- Complete the guided Windows practical for final windows productivity project.
- Apply the skill to an organised academic or workplace task.

Teaching Content

Key point: Create a logical project folder structure.

Key point: Use clear file names and archive/export folders.

Key point: Demonstrate search, Snap, Alt+Tab and at least five shortcuts.

Key point: Capture a privacy-safe screenshot.

Key point: Review storage and create a second copy of important work.

Key point: Finish with a clean organised workspace.

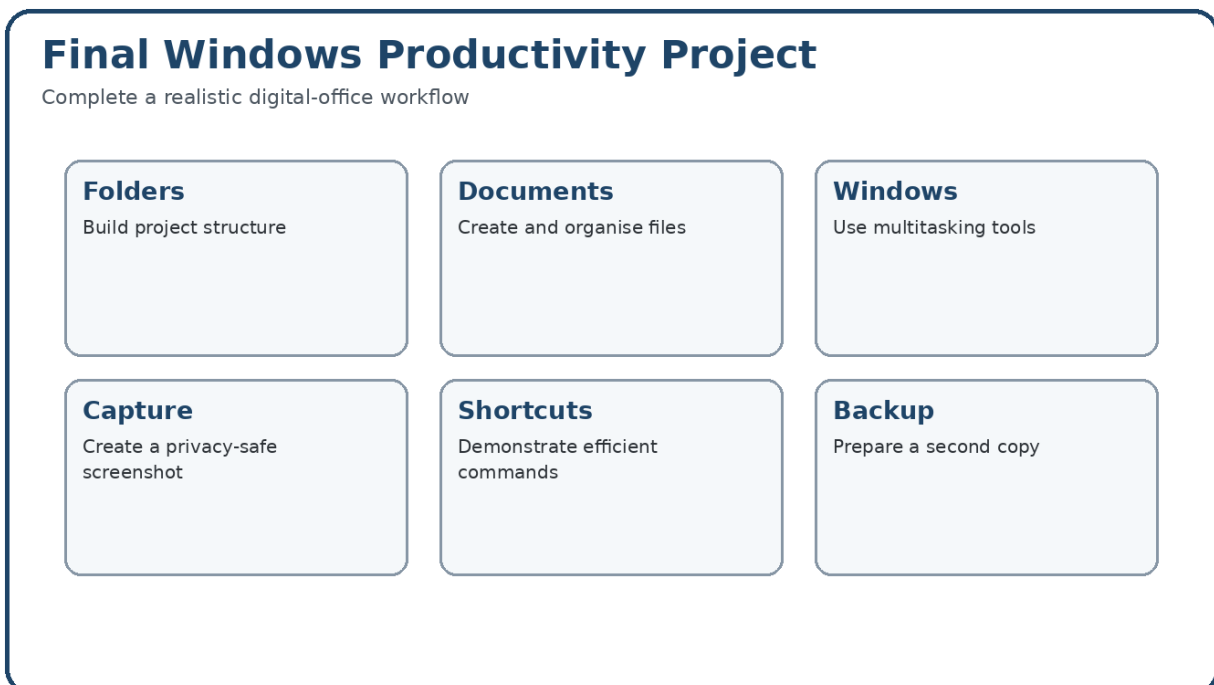


Figure 19: Instructional visual for Final Windows Productivity Project.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a fictional 'Ethan Digital Skills Workshop' project folder.
2. Add Current Work, Resources, Exports and Archive subfolders.
3. Create and organise three practice documents.
4. Use Windows Search to find one file.
5. Demonstrate window snapping and five shortcuts.
6. Capture and save one privacy-safe screenshot.
7. Create a backup copy and submit a short workflow report.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

This project demonstrates practical Windows skills that support every other Ethan Digital Academy course.

Review Questions

92. What is the productivity purpose of final windows productivity project?
93. State two Windows features or techniques from this lesson.
94. What mistake should a careful learner avoid?
95. How could this skill save time in an academic or office task?

Assignment

Repeat the Lesson 19 practical using harmless practice files. Submit a short note explaining the steps, the result and one way the skill improves your personal Windows workflow.

Final Practical Project - 100 Marks

Component	Marks	Requirement
Folder structure	15	Logical project folders and clear names.
File operations	15	Create, copy, move, rename, archive and restore practice files.
Search	10	Find apps/settings/files efficiently.
Window management	15	Use Snap and app switching.
Shortcuts	15	Demonstrate at least five useful shortcuts.
Screenshot/privacy	10	Capture and save only relevant information.
Security/storage/backup	10	Lock, review storage and create a second copy.
Workflow report	10	Explain the completed process clearly.

Course Quiz - 30 Questions

1. What is an operating system?
2. What is the Windows desktop?
3. What is the Start menu used for?
4. What is the taskbar?
5. What is File Explorer?
6. Why are meaningful file names useful?
7. What is the difference between Copy and Move?
8. What does Rename change?
9. What is Recycle Bin used for?
10. What can Windows Search find?
11. What does Minimise do?
12. What is Windows Snap?
13. What does Alt+Tab do?
14. What does Win+E do?
15. What does Win+D do?
16. What does Win+L do?
17. What is the clipboard?
18. What is clipboard history?
19. Why should sensitive data not be left in shared clipboard history?
20. What is Snipping Tool used for?
21. Why should screenshots be checked before sharing?
22. What is display scaling?
23. Name two Windows accessibility features.
24. What is Narrator?
25. Why can notifications reduce concentration?
26. Why should security alerts not simply be disabled?
27. Why does free storage matter?

28. What is the difference between sync and backup?
29. Name three parts of an organised Windows workflow.
30. List four skills required in the final project.

Final Examination - 100 Marks

Section A - Windows Interface (20 marks)

Explain desktop, Start, taskbar, File Explorer and Windows Search.

Section B - File and Window Management (20 marks)

Describe file organisation, file operations, Snap, app switching and virtual desktops.

Section C - Productivity Tools (20 marks)

Explain shortcuts, clipboard, screenshots, taskbar pins and notification management.

Section D - Settings, Accessibility and Safety (20 marks)

Explain normal user settings, accessibility features, security habits and storage management.

Section E - Integrated Workflow (20 marks)

Design a Windows workflow for completing and backing up an Ethan Digital Academy assignment.

Course Completion Outcome

After successful completion, the learner should be able to use Windows confidently for everyday academic and office productivity: navigate the interface, organise files, search efficiently, manage multiple windows, use shortcuts and clipboard tools, capture screenshots responsibly, adjust normal settings, use accessibility features, protect sessions, manage storage and maintain an organised backup-aware workflow.

Professional Practice Checklist

- Use clear file and folder names.
- Keep the desktop and Downloads organised.
- Use shortcuts only when their effect is understood.
- Review screenshots before sharing.
- Lock the device when leaving it unattended.
- Use official Windows settings and approved software.
- Keep an independent backup of important work.